4.2 CITIZENSHIP

4.2.1 Introduction

In political theory, citizenship refers not only to a legal status which means the ruled are full and equal participants in the political process. Democracy and citizenship go hand in hand. Citizenship focuses on the attributes of individual citizens. Citizens have certain rights that differ from one country to another.

Natural citizens are the citizens by virtue of their birth but naturalised citizens are the ones who acquire citizenship.

Aristotle defined citizenship with reference to the birth place, family lineage and culture.

4.2.2 Citizenship and the City-state:

Citizenship was an important theme in the ancient Greek and Roman Republics but they disappeared from the feudal systems. This was later revived as a desirable aspect of civic humanism during the Renaissance. Citizenship was considered only as participation of duties during the ancient Athens.

4.2.3 *Marshall's* Analysis

According to Marshall, a liberal-social democrat links citizenship to social class in the context of capitalism. citizenship has three essential divisions: civil, political and social. Every individual requires a right for freedom and that is what is in as civil component. As a citizen we have the right to participate in political decision-making process.

Aristotle

Defines citizenship as "he who has the power to take part in the deliberative or judicial administration of any state."

DO YOU KNOW?

The Maintenance and welfare of Parents and Senior Citizens Act was passed in 2007 by to provide maintenance and support to elderly parents and senior citizens.

What the Act states …

- The Act established the Maintenance Tribunal to provide speedy and effective relief to elderly person.
- Maintenance, according to the Act, pertains to "provision for food, clothing, residence and medical attendance and treatment".
- The only condition for claiming maintenance under this Act is that the persons must be unable to maintain themselves from their own earnings and property.
- The Act mandates that the maximum maintenance paid will be ₹ 10,000/- per month. The maintenance amount is determined by the needs of the claimant and the aim is provide maintenance for the person to lead a normal life.
- Parents or senior citizens can avail the services of the State government appointed maintenance officer to represent their interests during proceedings before the Maintenance Tribunal. Lawyers are not allowed to present cases before the Tribunal according to the Act.
- Any person who is responsible for the protection and care of a senior citizen and intentionally abandons the senior citizen completely is liable to pay a fine of ₹ 5000/- or be imprisoned for three months or both.

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